
Reprint These

TWELVE SHEETS • FIVE FOR HER, SEVEN FOR YOU

Everything else you printed is still current

How to use this file. Print the twelve pages after this one. They are in packet order, so you can swap each set for the pages it replaces and bin the old ones. Nothing else in the packet changed. The last seven are the game-master pages: they carry every instruction for what you write by hand, so use these and bin the old ones.

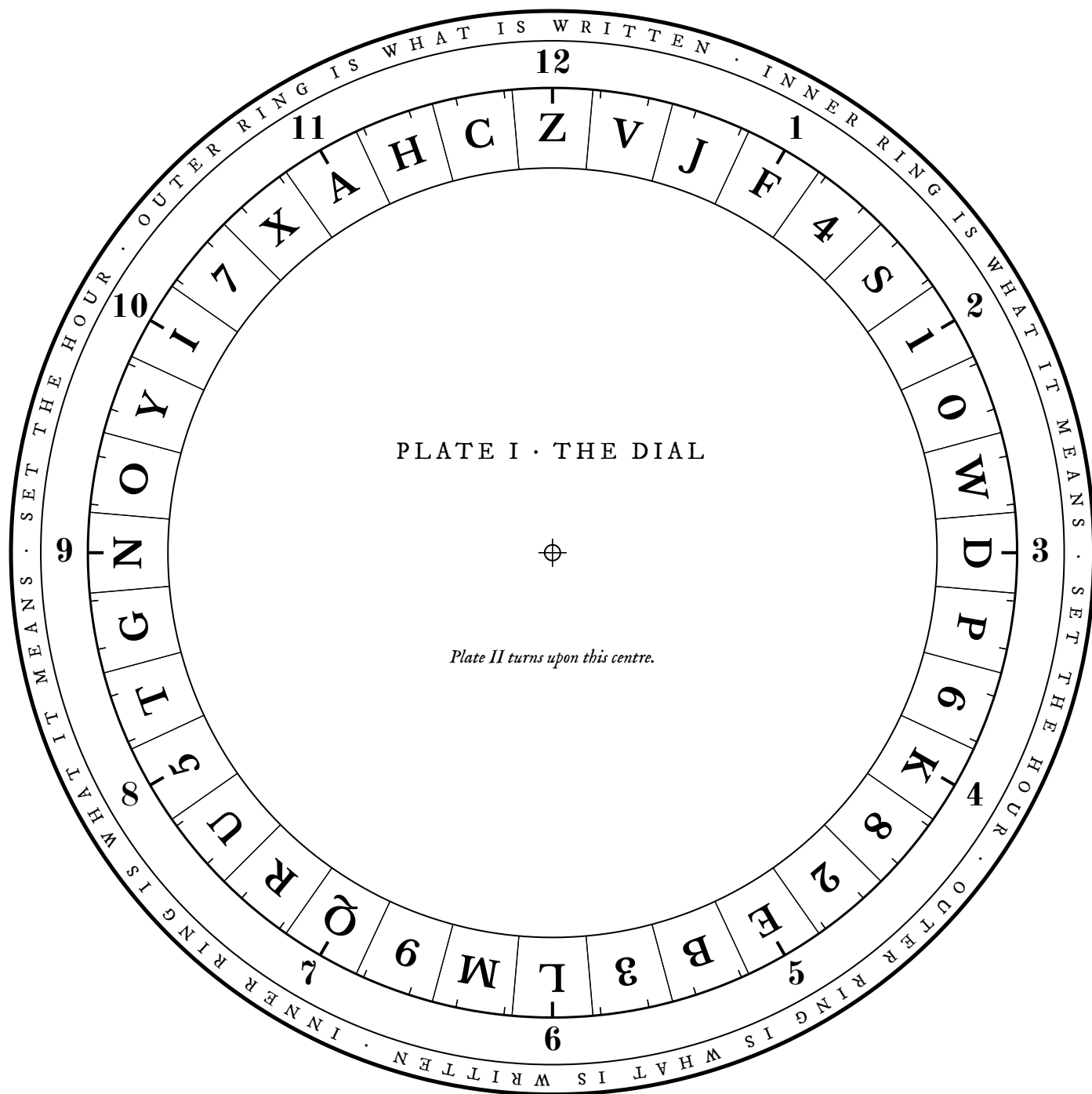
WHAT CHANGED AND WHY

PACKET PAGES	SHEETS	WHAT AND WHY
3-4	2	Cipher plates I and II Rim text no longer runs into the cut line. The rim and Plate II now say which ring is written and which is meant. The hour hand points straight at the 3 instead of halfway between 3 and 4.
26-27	2	Cartomancer's guide The Jokers are set as a fifth suit rather than a box at the foot of the page, so the one that matters does not announce itself. The real one is The Coloured Joker.
29	1	Pig-pen alphabet The dots no longer collide with the letters, and the alphabet is no longer the arrangement a search engine will hand her: the dotted figures hold the earlier letters. She can only read it from this sheet.
34	1	The wall, to trace (yours) Drawn in the new alphabet, so the old copy would have her decoding the wrong words. This is the sheet you copy the shapes from.
35-39	5	Setup guide (yours) The flowchart, the lock order, every hiding place, everything you write by hand, and the five tests.
40	1	Cipher solution (yours) Now quotes the rim's new wording and describes the hour hand correctly.

There is a second, optional file. It holds the songbook and the celebrity list, thirteen pages, and it only moves the Barista's Hornpipe and Ed Sheeran away from the top of their sheets. Your printed copies still work exactly as they are: the air still numbers the dotted half note 12 and the beamed eighths 15, which is all the puzzle needs. Reprint those only if the polish is worth thirteen sheets to you. If you skip one, skip both, since they were regenerated together.

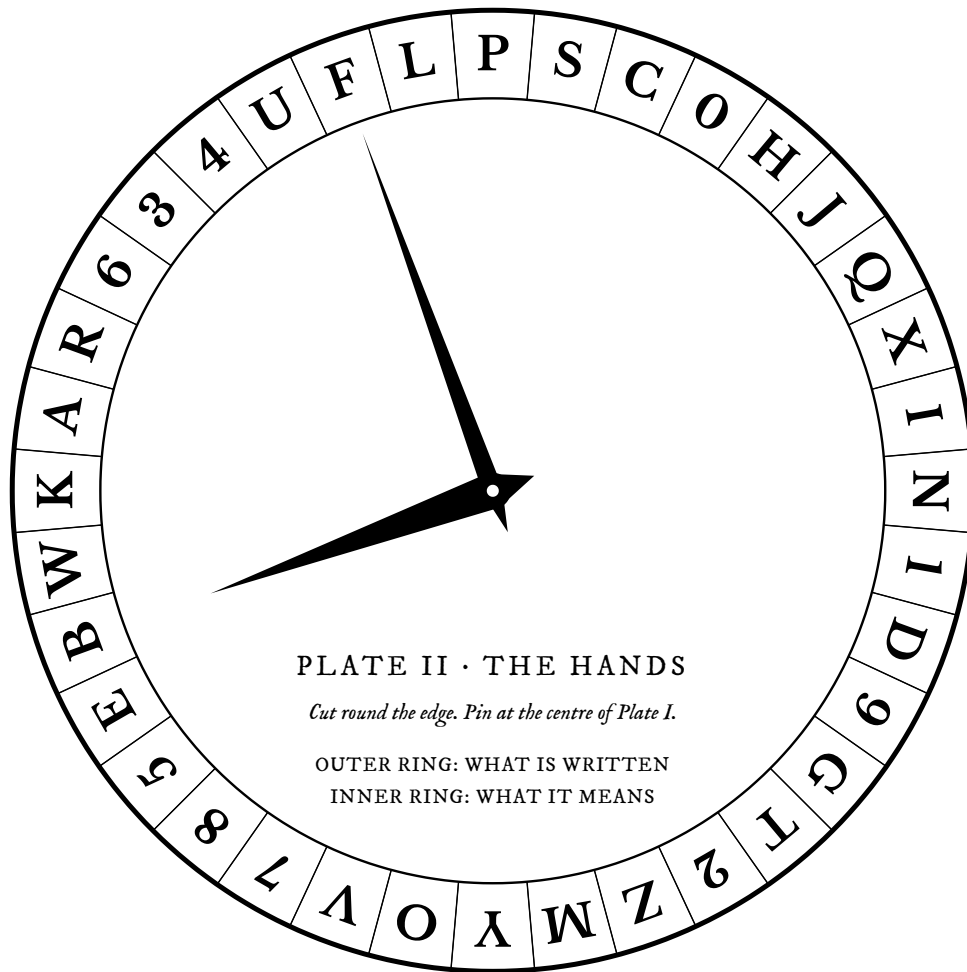
The Horological Cipher

PLATE I OF II · THE DIAL



The Horological Cipher

PLATE II OF II • THE HANDS



Cut round the edge and fasten upon the centre of Plate I with a pin, so that it turns freely. Set the hour.

The Cartomancer's Pocket Guide

THE MEANING OF EVERY CARD, AND WHERE ITS FORTUNE IS TO BE SOUGHT

As practised in the Kitchens of Europe · Sixth Printing

Draw a card, or be given one, or find one where no card ought to be. Read its meaning below, and then, if you are brave, go and look for its fortune in the place appointed. The places are traditional and have not been altered in six printings. The cards do not care whether you believe them.

♥ HEARTS — *matters of the heart*

ACE OF HEARTS — a new love, or an old one returning; its fortune is sought *in the cutlery drawer*.

TWO OF HEARTS — a meeting of two minds; its fortune is sought *beneath the doormat*.

THREE OF HEARTS — a letter that pleases; its fortune is sought *behind the clock*.

FOUR OF HEARTS — a change of dwelling; its fortune is sought *in a coat pocket*.

FIVE OF HEARTS — a gift given freely; its fortune is sought *under the bed*.

SIX OF HEARTS — a surprise visit; its fortune is sought *in the breadbox*.

SEVEN OF HEARTS — a broken promise, mended; its fortune is sought *in the coffee grinder*.

EIGHT OF HEARTS — an invitation; its fortune is sought *in the fruit bowl*.

NINE OF HEARTS — a wish granted; its fortune is sought *inside a shoe*.

TEN OF HEARTS — the family gathered; its fortune is sought *under the bathmat*.

JACK OF HEARTS — a warm-hearted friend; its fortune is sought *on the highest shelf*.

QUEEN OF HEARTS — a kind and loyal woman; its fortune is sought *at the back of the upstairs toilet, where a noble woman does not look twice*.

KING OF HEARTS — a generous man; its fortune is sought *in the toaster oven*.

♦ DIAMONDS — *matters of money and the house*

ACE OF DIAMONDS — a ring, or an important document; its fortune is sought *in the letterbox*.

TWO OF DIAMONDS — a small quarrel over a small sum; its fortune is sought *behind the curtains*.

THREE OF DIAMONDS — a legal matter; its fortune is sought *in the umbrella stand*.

FOUR OF DIAMONDS — an inheritance; its fortune is sought *inside a book of poems*.

FIVE OF DIAMONDS — a prosperous venture; its fortune is sought *in the medicine cabinet*.

SIX OF DIAMONDS — an early marriage; its fortune is sought *in the vegetable drawer*.

SEVEN OF DIAMONDS — a loss, soon recovered; its fortune is sought *under the kettle*.

EIGHT OF DIAMONDS — a journey by land; its fortune is sought *in the sewing box*.

NINE OF DIAMONDS — a restless night; its fortune is sought *behind the mirror*.

TEN OF DIAMONDS — money from an unexpected quarter; its fortune is sought *in the laundry basket*.

JACK OF DIAMONDS — a messenger with news; its fortune is sought *in the spice drawer*.

QUEEN OF DIAMONDS — a woman fond of gossip; its fortune is sought *beneath the rug*.

KING OF DIAMONDS — a man of business; its fortune is sought *in the fridge door*.

♣ CLUBS — *matters of work and friendship*

ACE OF CLUBS — wealth and good fortune; its fortune is sought *under the sink*.

TWO OF CLUBS — an opposition overcome; its fortune is sought *in the sugar jar*.

THREE OF CLUBS — a happy marriage; its fortune is sought *in the bag of rice*.

FOUR OF CLUBS — a change for the worse, then better; its fortune is sought *behind the radiator*.

FIVE OF CLUBS — help from a friend; its fortune is sought *in the toolbox*.

SIX OF CLUBS — a business success; its fortune is sought *under the stairs*.

SEVEN OF CLUBS — a secret admirer; its fortune is sought *in the bath*.

EIGHT OF CLUBS — a run of good luck at games; its fortune is sought *on the windowsill*.

NINE OF CLUBS — a new friendship; its fortune is sought *in the sock drawer*.

TEN OF CLUBS — a long journey; its fortune is sought *nestled in the mixing bowls*.

JACK OF CLUBS — a dark-haired young man; its fortune is sought *in the hall closet*.

QUEEN OF CLUBS — a woman of quick temper; its fortune is sought *in the recycling*.

KING OF CLUBS — a faithful friend; its fortune is sought *at the bottom of the wardrobe*.

♠ SPADES — *matters of trouble and change*

ACE OF SPADES — a misfortune, or a great decision; its fortune is sought *in the tea caddy*.

TWO OF SPADES — a deception; its fortune is sought *under the lamp*.

THREE OF SPADES — a parting; its fortune is sought *in the bicycle basket*.

FOUR OF SPADES — illness, briefly; its fortune is sought *inside the chess set*.

FIVE OF SPADES — a difficulty at home; its fortune is sought *behind the books*.

SIX OF SPADES — a change of heart; its fortune is sought *in the freezer*.

SEVEN OF SPADES — a loss of a friend; its fortune is sought *in the desk drawer*.

EIGHT OF SPADES — a caution against haste; its fortune is sought *under the cutting board*.

NINE OF SPADES — the worst card, and then it passes; its fortune is sought *under the television*.

TEN OF SPADES — a night of worry; its fortune is sought *in the dishwasher*.

JACK OF SPADES — an untrustworthy young man; its fortune is sought *in a tub of protein powder*.

QUEEN OF SPADES — a widow, or a woman alone; its fortune is sought *in the salt cellar*.

KING OF SPADES — an ambitious man; its fortune is sought *inside the Coup box*.

♦ JOKERS — *matters that fit nowhere else*

THE COLOURED JOKER — the fool who knows everything and says nothing; its fortune is sought *in the Dutch oven*.

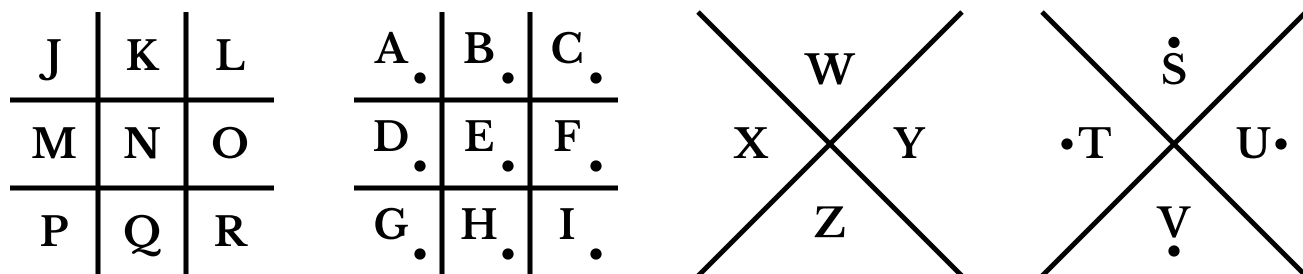
THE BLACK JOKER — the fool who says everything and knows nothing; its fortune is sought *inside a rolled-up yoga mat*.

The Pig-Pen Alphabet

A KEY TO THE CIPHER OF THE FREEMASONS, THE ROSICRUCIANS, AND SCHOOLCHILDREN

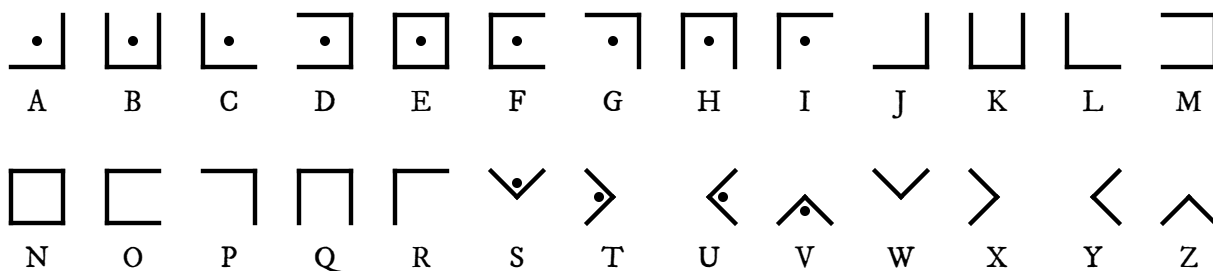
Pocket Library Series · No. 4

Each letter is written not by its name but by the shape of the pen it lives in. Find the letter in one of the four figures below and draw the lines that enclose it, and nothing else; the dot marks the second set. To read a message, do the same in reverse: match the shape to its pen, and take the letter that sits in it. The alphabet is set out in full underneath for the impatient. Note that these pens are not arranged as every printer arranges them; trust this sheet and nothing else.



The four pens, left to right: J to R, then A to I with a dot, then W to Z, then S to V with a dot.

THE ALPHABET IN FULL



FOR PRACTICE

The line below reads: THE QUICK BROWN FOX JUMPS OVER THE LAZY DOG



The Wall

TWO INKS, ONE LINE

Game-master copy · not for Sarah · remove before she arrives

Line one, in dry-erase marker, large: **ALIEN BLUES**.

Line two, beneath it, laid out exactly as below. The *italic words* go in dry-erase marker. The **shapes** go in the invisible-ink pen; the small grey letter over each shape is what it means, so copy the shapes, never the letters. Leave a clear gap between every word. 22 shapes in all.

ALIEN BLUES

B	R	E	A	T	H	E	marker	B	R	E	A	T	H	E	marker	marker
◻	◻	◻	◻	◻	◻	◻	<i>in</i>	◻	◻	◻	◻	◻	◻	◻	<i>out</i>	<i>open</i>
marker	G	R	E	E	N	marker	marker	S	I	T	marker					
<i>the</i>	◻	◻	◻	◻	◻	<i>thing</i>	<i>you</i>	◻	◻	◻	<i>on</i>					

Line two reads, all together: **BREATHE IN BREATHE OUT OPEN THE GREEN THING YOU SIT ON**. Hidden words only:
BREATHE BREATHE GREEN SIT.

GAME-MASTER COPY · THE WALL

GAME-MASTER'S SETUP GUIDE • REMOVE THESE LEAVES BEFORE SHE ARRIVES

MINUTE ONE

HANDED TO HER: the letter and the Milk Crate painting.
The letter gives her the address sarahs.quest.

OUT IN THE OPEN: seven printed sheets (not the pig-pen key, not the plates),
the flyer, the lemons, the knife AND the scale, The Prophet, the locked suitcase.

OPEN AT THE SAME TIME • two lines, either order

Milk Crate painting, back → Ed Sheeran

Stars and Their Notes → The Barista's Hornpipe, two notes

Parlour Songbook, those two shapes → 12 and 15

Concordance + The Prophet, pages 12 and 15 → CORN BREAD

Receipt Book, cornbread → a game of backgammon

HIDE IN THE BACKGAMMON SET:
Plate II (the small disc with the hands) + Patricia painting

Put the knife on the scale → 79 g

Knife Catalogue, 79 g → No. 9, the Lemonade Knife

Cut the lemons open → the Joker

Cartomancer's Guide, the Joker → in the Dutch oven

HIDE IN THE DUTCH OVEN:
Plate I (the big dial), with a paper fastener taped to it

OPENS WHEN THE MUSIC LINE IS DONE

Patricia painting → Register → a small painted egg...

HIDE IN THE WINGSPAN BOX:
Hamlet painting · fairy painting · a Queen of Hearts

THREE AT ONCE • any order

Queen of Hearts → Cartomancer's Guide
→ the back of the upstairs toilet

HIDE IN THE TOILET CISTERN:
the BLACK key (opens the suitcase)

Hamlet → Hamnet → Chloé Zhao
→ Register, Chloe → a jar of sweets

HIDE IN THE CANDY JAR:
blue-light pen · Abyssinia + Gleaners paintings

Fairy houses → Shirley
→ Register → a bottle kept for company

HIDE IN THE LIQUOR CABINET:
the Pig-Pen Alphabet sheet

THE LOCK • needs a piece from every line

Abyssinia + Gleaners + pigpen sheet → sarahs.quest. Ethiopia is
Figure VII (HALF PAST), Italy is Figure XIV (THREE) ALLEN BLUES in marker; then BREATHE in BREATHE out open the GREEN thing you SIT c

Flyer → bathroom. Blue-light pen + pigpen sheet

HIDE INSIDE THE MEDITATION CUSHION:
the card: DW₅OY₇ H₃W VKYJ LKRWQ

THE WHEEL: pin Plate II (hands) on Plate I (dial), set 3:30, decode the card
DW₅OY₇ H₃W VKYJ LKRWQ = BEHIND THE MANY FACES

HIDE BEHIND THE FRAMED PHOTO PUZZLE: the DARK BLUE key

BLACK key, from the cistern, opens the SUITCASE
early on. Inside: the backpack, still locked.

DARK BLUE key opens the BACKPACK
the prize

Nothing can be shortcut: the card is unreadable without both plates and the time, and those come from three different places.

THE CONCORDANCE

The one-page sheet headed "A Reader's Concordance" with "The Prophet, by Kahlil Gibran" printed under the masthead. It gives one word-counting rule for each of 84 pages. She needs a real copy of The Prophet to use it; the sheet itself names the book, so put the book on the shelf among others and nothing more is needed.

PLATE I AND PLATE II

"Plate" always means one of the two cipher discs, and nothing else. Plate I, The Dial, is the big circle with clock numerals round the rim. Plate II, The Hands, is the smaller circle with two clock hands on it. Cut both out. Tape a paper fastener to Plate I (the brass pin with a round head and two flat legs, from any office-supply shop; a pushpin into cardboard works too); she lays Plate II on top and turns it until the hands read 3:30. So "hide Plate I in the Dutch oven" simply means: put the big disc in the Dutch oven.

FIGURE I TO FIGURE XX

The twenty flag cards on sarahs.quest. They carry no country names, only numbers, so Figure VII is the seventh card along. She never needs the number; she recognises Ethiopia and Italy by their colours. The numbers are only here so you can check the right card without counting.

PIGPEN

A cipher where each letter is drawn as the walls of the box it sits in. The printed Pig-Pen Alphabet sheet is the key. The only pigpen you write by hand is the wall; the flags' pigpen is already on the website.

WHEEL SYMBOLS

Ordinary letters and digits that only mean something once the wheel is set. You copy them onto the cushion card exactly as printed below.

LOCK AND LOAD, IN THIS ORDER, SO NO KEY ENDS UP LOCKED INSIDE ITS OWN BOX

1. Put the prize in the backpack. Close it and padlock it. Its key is **DARK BLUE**.
2. Put the backpack inside the suitcase. Close the suitcase and padlock it. Its key is **BLACK**.
3. Stand the suitcase somewhere she will see it all evening. It is meant to taunt.
4. Hide **BLACK** in a ziplock in the toilet cistern. She reaches it mid-game, opens the suitcase, and finds the backpack still locked. That is the moment the evening turns.
5. Tape **DARK BLUE** flat to the back of the framed photo puzzle. Masking tape, pressed down so it cannot rattle. Nothing points here until the wheel is decoded.
6. **PURPLE** and **LIGHT BLUE** are not used. Put them in a drawer.

Two locks is the whole scheme. The wheel exists to produce the second key, so it cannot be skipped.

EVERY HIDING PLACE AND WHAT GOES IN IT

PLACE	CONTENTS
HER HANDS	The welcome letter and the Milk Crate painting. Nothing is hidden on the painting; its back just carries the written clue.
OUT IN THE OPEN	Seven printed sheets scattered about: knife catalogue, songbook, Stars and Their Notes, receipt book, register, cartomancer's guide, concordance. NOT the pig-pen key (liquor cabinet) and NOT the two plates (backgammon set, Dutch oven). Also the flyer on the fridge; a bowl of lemons, one loaded; the knife and the kitchen scale on the counter; The Prophet on the shelf among many books; the locked suitcase
BACKGAMMON SET	Plate II; the Patricia painting
WINGSPAN BOX	The Hamlet painting; the fairy painting; a real Queen of Hearts playing card
TOILET CISTERN	The BLACK key in a ziplock bag. Nothing else, ever. No paper, no paintings.
THE CANDY JAR	The blue-light pen; the Abyssinia painting; the Gleaners painting. Roll the paintings or lay them under the jar if they will not fit inside.
LIQUOR CABINET	The Pig-Pen Alphabet key sheet
DUTCH OVEN	Plate I, with a paper fastener taped to it (the brass pin with two flat legs; she pushes it through both discs and bends the legs back so the top disc spins)
BATHROOM WALL OR MIRROR	ALIEN BLUES in dry-erase marker; the pigpen glyphs from the tracing sheet in invisible ink beneath
INSIDE THE MEDITATION CUSHION	The cipher card, in a small envelope, tucked just inside the zip where a hand will meet it
BEHIND THE FRAMED PHOTO PUZZLE	The DARK BLUE key, taped flat to the back of the frame. Nothing points here until the wheel is decoded, so it is never searched.
SUITCASE	The backpack. The suitcase itself is padlocked with the BLACK lock and left in plain sight all evening.
BACKPACK	The prize. Padlocked with the DARK BLUE lock. All six paintings are placed elsewhere; none is in here.

1 • THE WELCOME LETTER. Your words, your handwriting. It must do three jobs and no more: give her the address `sarahs.quest`; warn her that some things she finds will not make sense on the day she finds them; and end with a line in your own voice. Do not explain any puzzle. Do not mention the suitcase. If you are stuck for an opening: *“There are six paintings in this apartment and every one of them is a question. You will need a scale, a knife, a pin, and more patience than I deserve.”*

2 • THE SIX PAINTING BACKS. Write these on the quarter-sheet frames and clip or tape one to each painting.

MILK CRATE — *The famous man we always see here, who is not him.*

PATRICIA’S — *Just the name. Look her up.*

HAMLET — *We saw the film of this play. Whose film was it? Look her up by her first name.*

FAIRY HOUSES — *What was the family name of the one who lived here? Look her up.*

ABYSSINIA — *This country has another name now. Find its colours at `sarahs.quest`, and turn them over.*

GLEANERS — *The café sits in a market named for a country. Its colours are at `sarahs.quest` too. You will need this one and Abyssinia both.*

3 • THE WALL. Two inks on one surface. The tracing sheet two pages back shows the whole thing laid out.

LINE ONE, DRY-ERASE MARKER, LARGE: ALIEN BLUES

LINE TWO, MIXED. The lowercase words go in dry-erase marker. The CAPITAL words go in invisible ink, as pig-pen shapes, in the gaps:

BREATHE in BREATHE out open the GREEN thing you SIT on

So what she sees walking in is *ALIEN BLUES* / ___ in ___ out open the ___ thing you ___ on, a sentence with holes in it. Under the blue light the holes fill with shapes, and with the pig-pen sheet the shapes read BREATHE, BREATHE, GREEN, SIT. That is 22 shapes to draw. The visible words give nothing away; the hidden ones are the answer, so she still needs the pen and the sheet. Test a corner first: glass and glazed tile wipe clean, grout and stone do not. The mirror is the safest surface in the room.

4 • THE CIPHER CARD. Any scrap of paper. In capitals, exactly, with the spaces where they are:

DW5OY7 H5W VKYJ LKRWQ

Put it in a small envelope. On the envelope write: *This will mean nothing until the hour is set.* Tuck it just inside the cushion’s zip, where a hand will meet it straight away.

5 • THREE HINT ENVELOPES (optional, but they save the evening). Seal three envelopes and label them *If you are stuck on the music*, *If you are stuck on the knife*, and *If you are stuck at the very end*. Inside each, one sentence: *Everything you need is at `sarahs.quest/hints.html` — and I will not think less of you.*

WHAT YOU DO NOT WRITE

The flags’ pigpen is already on the website. The register, the card guide, the concordance, the songbook, the knife catalogue and the recipe book are printed and final. The only cipher you draw by hand is the wall.

THE FIVE TESTS, BEFORE SHE ARRIVES

1. **The knife.** Put your real knife on your real scale. It must read 79 g. The nearest catalogue entries are 58 g and 99 g, so you have about 14 g of slack either way. If it is wildly off, pick a different knife.
2. **The book.** Open your copy of *The Prophet*. Page 12, fourth word of the first line, must be **corn**. Page 15, the first sentence beginning “Give”, sixth word, must be **bread**. Editions differ and this is the single most likely thing to break.
3. **The wall.** Shine the blue-light pen on your writing. The hidden shapes must show clearly between the marker words. Then wipe a corner to be certain both inks come off.
4. **The wheel.** Cut both plates, pin them, set the hands to half past three, and decode the cipher card yourself. It must read BEHIND THE MANY FACES.
5. **The website.** Open [sarahs.quest](#) on your phone. Tap Figure VII, the green-yellow-red flag with the blue disc: its back must read HALF PAST. Then tap Figure XIV, the green-white-red vertical stripes: its back must read THREE. Together they give half past three.

THE ORDER TO SET THE ROOM UP

1. Lock the backpack, put it in the suitcase, lock the suitcase, stand it in the open.
2. Hide the two keys: BLACK in the cistern, DARK BLUE behind the framed puzzle.
3. Place all six paintings: Milk Crate in her envelope; Patricia in the backgammon set; Hamlet and the fairy houses in the Wingspan box with the Queen of Hearts; Abyssinia and Gleaners with the candy jar. None goes in the backpack.
4. Plate II in the backgammon set. Plate I in the Dutch oven. Pig-pen sheet in the liquor cabinet.
5. Load one lemon with the Joker and set the bowl out. Knife and scale on the counter.
6. Cipher card into the cushion. Write the wall. Flyer on the fridge.
7. Scatter the seven open sheets around the room: knife catalogue, songbook, Stars and Their Notes, receipt book, register, cartomancer’s guide, concordance. *The Prophet* onto the shelf among other books. Keep the pig-pen key and both plates for their hiding places.
8. Tear the last six leaves out of the printed packet and hide them from yourself.

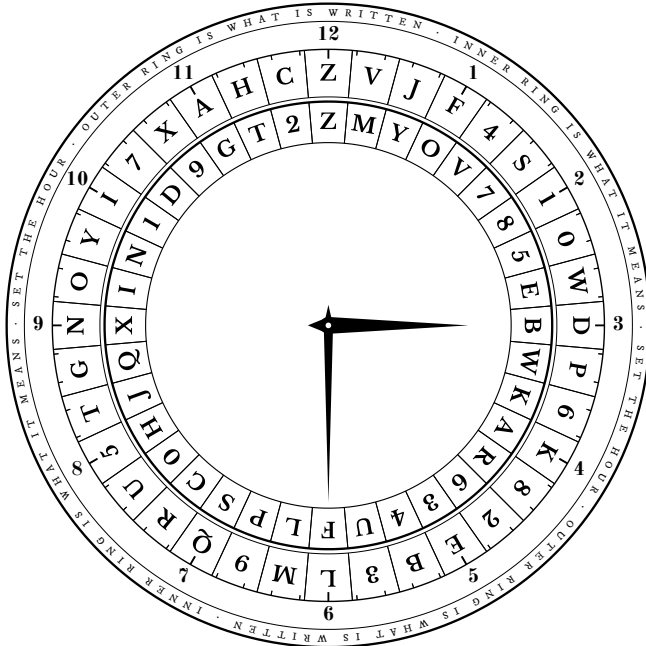
IF SHE STALLS

[sarahs.quest/hints.html](#) holds eighteen predicaments, each with a nudge, then a firmer nudge, then the answer outright. It is linked in a box at the top of the flags page, so she can reach it on her own and you never have to be the one who gives it away. Or just tell her; you are allowed.

Cipher Solution Sheet

FOR THE GAME-MASTER ONLY • DO NOT PRINT FOR SARAH

How it works. Plate II (the hands) is pinned on top of Plate I (the dial) and turned until the hands read **3:30** on the dial's clock numerals: the short hand pointing straight at the **3** and the long hand straight at the **6**. That is a turn of 200° clockwise from the printed position. The rim of the dial says *outer ring is what is written, inner ring is what it means*: a secret message is written in **dial symbols**; for each one, find it on the outer dial and read the symbol lined up with it on the inner disc. Letters and digits both take part, so you can hide a number, a time, or a word.



Dial	Hands	Dial	Hands	Dial	Hands
A	G	B	4	C	2
D	B	E	3	F	0
G	Q	H	T	I	1
J	Y	K	A	L	F
M	L	N	X	O	I
P	W	Q	S	R	C
S	7	T	J	U	0
V	M	W	E	X	9
Y	N	Z	Z	0	5
1	8	2	6	3	U
4	V	5	H	6	K
7	D	8	R	9	P

Example. Plain: LOOK BEHIND THE MIRROR AT 3 30

Written for Sarah (dial symbols): MFF6 DW50Y7 H5W VO88F8 KH E EU

To make your own: `python3 escape-room/src/cipher_data.py YOUR MESSAGE HERE`

Plate II's hands are deliberately printed at an angle that reads as no sensible time; only when turned 200° do they show 3:30. If you would rather a different answer, change `SOLUTION_TIME`, `HOURL_ANGLE`, `MINUTE_ANGLE` and `ROT` in `src/cipher_data.py` (`ROT` must be a multiple of 10) and rebuild.